

ASSIGNMENT 3

DESI 2701

This is a continuation from Assignment 2 and I am still exploring in the Stress category, specifically Class Difficulties

Today's agenda

ONLINE SURVEY SET-UP



ONLINE SURVEY RESULTS



INTERVIEW PROTOCOL



INTERVIEW RESULTS



EMPATHY MAPS



THANK YOU

Monday 16's agenda

ONLINE SURVEY SET-UP - PLANS & GOALS

PLANS:

- Write down 10-13 questions (Total: 11)
- Share it friends that I know who can fill it out
 - I am planning to share it with 3 groups
 - The Wrestling Program since I am a Team Manager for the program
 - 2 Discord Servers
 - Pugly Sever
 - ZNN (Zootopia News Network) Sever



GOALS:

- Getting above 10 people is nice, but I would like to get around 50 people to fill out my survey
- Getting about 10 people from different colleges would be nice

Update (Post Survey Time):

- I got 47 people to fill out my survey.
 - The survey link that I shared it to my friends filled it out
 - The wrestling team filled it out
 - One person from the Pugly server filled it out
 - No one on the ZNN server filled it out

Wednesday 18's agenda

ONLINE SURVEY SET-UP - QUESTIONS

What grade are you? *

- ☐ Freshman
- ☐ Sophomore
- ☐ Junior
- ☐ Senior
- ☐ Senior+ (Graduating behind)
- ☐ Graduate (Masters/PHD)
- ☐ I already graduated
- ☐ Other: _____

What college/school you attend/did you attend? Please spell it out like: University of Minnesota, Iowa State University, etc...

Short answer text

What is your Major/did you Major in? Please spell it out (Ex: Computer Engineering) *

Short answer text

Are you pursuing a Minor or did you complete a Minor? *

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

If you selected yes to the previous question, please say what are you Minor in/did you Minor in. Please spell it out (Ex: Product Design). If you aren't doing a Minor, just put down none

Short answer text

With all the classes you are taking/have taken, what are your top 3 most difficult classes. Please spell out the class name *

Short answer text

With the top 3 classes you choose, why are they difficult? Poor professor, workload, or something else? You can list more than one reason *

- ☐ Workload
- ☐ Not a great Professor (They can't teach well, disorganized, etc)
- ☐ Difficult to understand the topics of the course
- ☐ Lack of Optimistic (Not believing in yourself that you can do well in the class)
- ☐ The pacing of the class (the class goes over topics way too fast or unnecessarily way too long)
- ☐ Bad study habits
- ☐ Harsh graders (Professors or TAs not giving you particle credit)
- ☐ Other: _____

How much time do you spend on homework per week? *

- ☐ 0 - 2 hours
- ☐ 2 - 4 hours
- ☐ 4 - 6 hours
- ☐ 6+ hours

If you are struggling with any of your classes, what items do you wish that could be a thing that can help you with your difficult classes? *

Long answer text

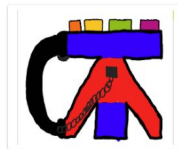
These are my 10 silly ideas, out of all the 10 ideas, what is your top 3 picks? *



☐ FOX SUPPORTS: An iPhone that helps study with subjects in a class that students are struggling to understand



☐ SCOOPSKI POTATO PROBLEMS: An app that can give you example problems based the topics you are learning to improve your knowledge



☐ TA CALL-INS: Students getting the opportunity to call their TAs for the class to get help with homework problems and ask questions



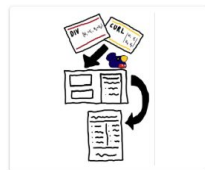
☐ OBJECTION ANSWER: A judge hammer that would tell you if you got the answer correct or incorrect. If you get it wrong, the hammer will tell the student the correct



☐ MR. CLEAN'S GRADE ERASER: Gives student the power to get rid off the worst grade they have in the class or remove a terrible grade on their transcript



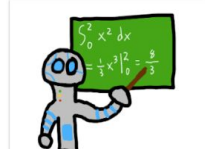
☐ MR. Z's AI: A legal AI website for students to use to support their learning and writing (like grammarly), but it won't give out answers



☐ GAR-SHEETS: A website that helps students create cheat sheets or a quick summary of the lecture slides so students can avoid confusion and delay



☐ THE HOWTOBASIC BOOK ON ACADEMICS: A magic book that contains all the courses at your college with lecture slides and has a lot of practice problems



☐ ROBO TEACH: When students are stress out on difficult subjects, ROBO TEACH can come to the rescue and help out for the student's success in the difficulty of the class. It's like ROZ from The Wild Robot but in an academic setting



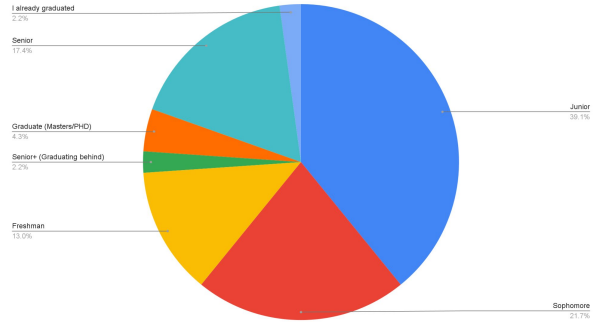
☐ BULLET EXAM: A model bullet train that can display and print past exams for that hard class and give students practice problems to get them prepare for upcoming exams

Of the 3 silly ideas you selected from the previous question, why did you select them? How do you see yourself using those items for your difficult classes? Do you think that you'll use it a lot? *

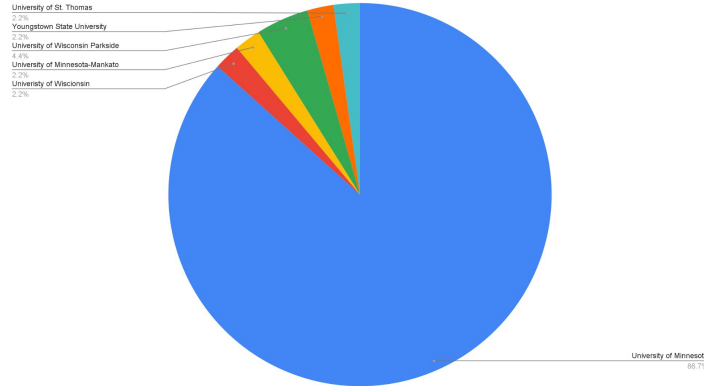
Your answer

ONLINE SURVEY RESULTS - GRADES & SCHOOL

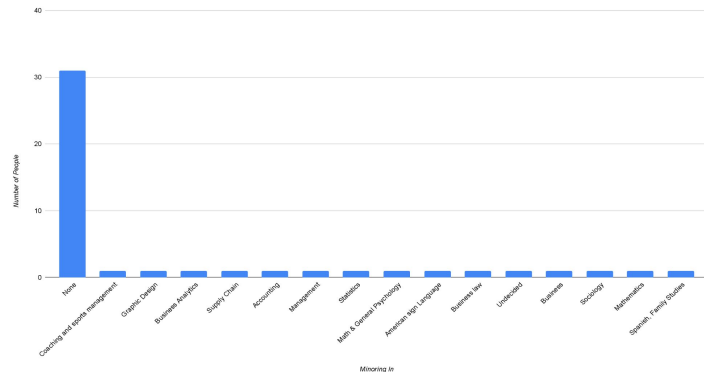
GRADES



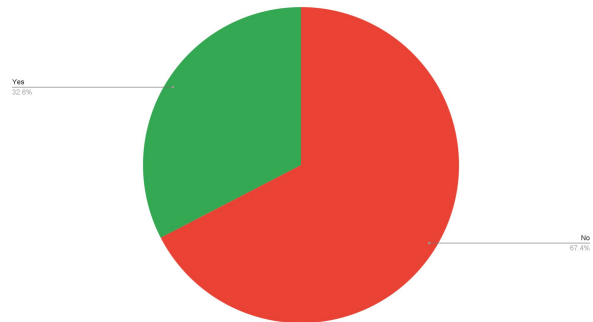
COLLEGE/SCHOOL ATTENDING/ATTENDED



STUDENTS MINORING IN



PURSUIING A MINOR?



SUMMARY OF ALL GRAPHS

GRADES

- Freshman - 13.0%
- Sophomore - 21.7%
- Junior - 39.1%
- Senior - 17.4%
- Senior+ - 2.2%
- Graduate - 4.3%
- Graduated - 2.2%

COLLEGE/SCHOOL ATTENDING/ATTENDED

- Majority are attending University of Minnesota

PURSUIING A MINOR?

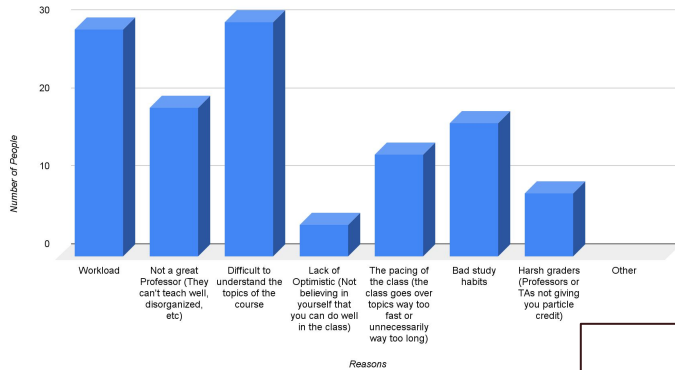
- 67.4% said "NO"

STUDENTS MINORING IN

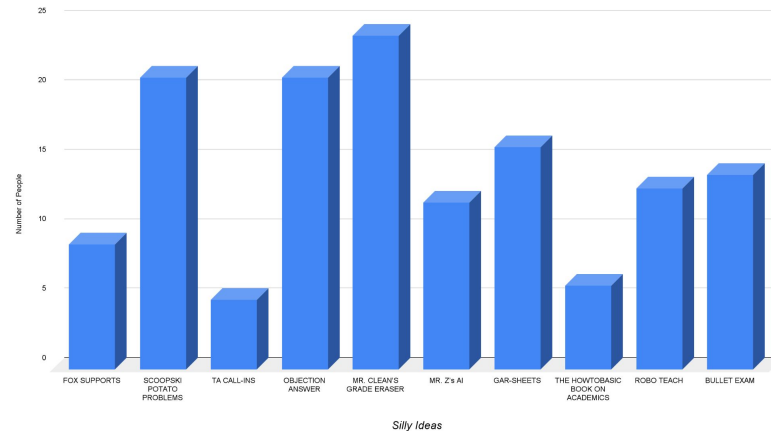
- A variety of students are minoring in something

ONLINE SURVEY RESULTS - REASONS & SILLY IDEAS

REASONS WHY THE CLASS IS DIFFICULT



WHAT SILLY IDEAS WOULD YOU USE TO HELP YOU WITH YOUR CLASS DIFFICULTIES?



SUMMARY OF ALL GRAPHS

REASONS

- The top 3 reasons why the class is difficult are:
 - Workload
 - Difficult to understand the content
 - Bad study habits

I am not surprised with this

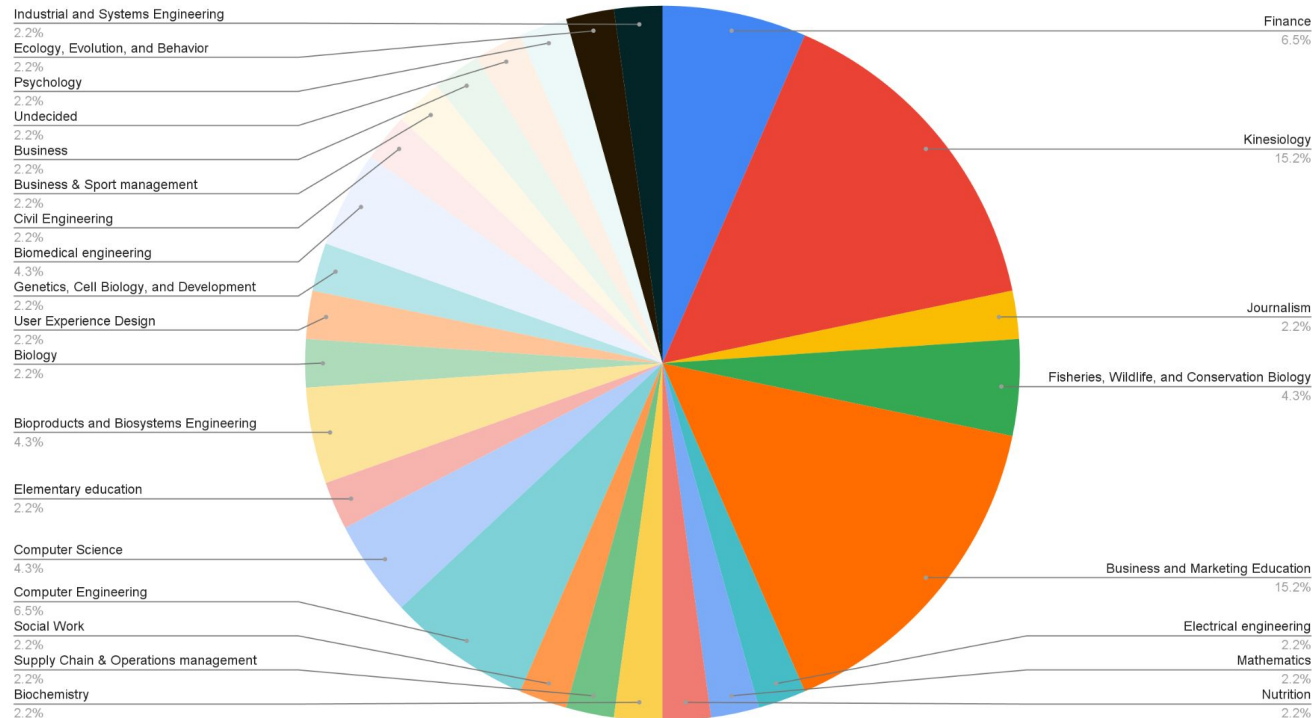
SILLY IDEAS

- The top 3 Silly Ideas are:
 - Mr. Clean's Grade Eraser
 - Scoopski Potato Problems
 - Objection Hammer

I am surprised to see that Objection Hammer would get a lot of votes

ONLINE SURVEY RESULTS - SHORT RESPONSES

MAJORS STUDENTS ARE DOING



SUMMARY OF ALL GRAPHS

MAJORS

A lot are majoring kinesiology, business and marketing education, computer engineering, and finance

DIFFICULT CLASSES

The classes that I see mentioned the most are:

- Multivariable Calculus
- Physics II
- Excel
- EE 3015
- EE 3115

WISH ITEMS

- "A device to inject the knowledge in my head instantly"
- "Better access to tutors, clearer and more numerous in-class examples"
- "24/7 office hours"
- "an mini professor who can always answer my questions that acts exactly like them and always has the right answer, unlike the internet. Then I could just talk to them..."

WHY THOSE ITEM IDEAS

- "For most of my classes the major time sink is studying in order to commit everything to memory. So having tools that will provide quick summaries and practice problems would save a lot of time and be the most useful. Also, being able to remove my worst grade in any class would be sweet. Would use that as much as possible."
- "I selected these 3 because they will help with learning and studying. I see myself using these items to help me get prepared for class assignments. I think I might use these when I need them."
- "Being able to erase your worst grade would be very helpful, it would also allow for less stress, going into certain exams or quizzes, knowing that if you bomb one, you are able to get rid of that low grade"

INTERVIEW PROTOCOL

Stress: Class Difficulty

The purpose of this interview is to gather a lot of data and information from students about class difficulty, which I consider this under the stress category, and my goal for this interview is to understand why students are struggling with classes and to know how you would improve if the class difficulty is too much for you to handle and improve difficult classes in general.]

Here are my questions for you, starting with...

1. How has your day been so far today?
2. Before doing this interview, what activities were you doing?
3. Tell me about yourself. What grade are you? What college/school do you attend/did you attend? What is your Major and are you doing a Minor or not? If yes you are doing a minor, what is it?
4. Knowing that you are a(n) [undergraduate/graduate] student going for [major/masters] and [minor (if they are pursuing one)], with all the classes you are taking/have taken, what are your top 3 most difficult classes.
5. With the top 3 classes you said, why are they difficult? Poor professor, workload, or something else? You can list more than one reason
6. How much time do you spend on homework per week? This is including studying for exams
7. If you are struggling with any of your classes, what items do you wish that could be a thing that can help you with your difficult classes?

8. What makes you stressed out besides classes? Why is that stressing you out?

- a. Do you think that the stresses that you mention are why classes are becoming difficult for you

9. Tell me the last time you got super stressed out over a class or school? What happened at that moment?

- a. Why was it a challenge?
- b. How did you overcome that challenge?
- c. Questions about their back story

10. Is there anything else you want to say about this topic?

BACK UPS

1. What goals do you have in mind to improve on the classes that are difficult to you?
2. Does the stress of the difficult classes help you motivate for improvement or cause you unmotivation? Why?
3. How would you improve class difficulties as a professor/TA? Would it be like being a lenient professor/TA, hosting more OHs, or something else?

4. Do you have a disability? If yes, what is your disability and do you think that it affects your class performance and causes your classes to be difficult?

5. As a student, what is your belief in class difficulties? Should all classes be easy, lenient, in between, hard, difficult, or difficult+?

6. How often do you get sick? Do you think that being is one of your causes to make classes difficult?

INTERVIEW RESULTS - PERSON 1



NAME: Silas Orta

COLLEGE: University of
Montana

GRADE: Sophomore

MAJOR/MINOR: Journalism,
Graphic Design

LOCATION: Online @ Discord

DATE: 2/22/2026

TIME: 3:00PM

ITEMS THAT THEY WISH TO HAVE FOR ACADEMIC USES

An item that Silas wishes to have is one of my silly ideas which is Mr. Clean's Grade Eraser because he can focus on other assignments that are very important to him and come back to those assignments later. It can be a life saver for him.

DIFFICULT ACADEMIC TIME

"I got pretty stressed just a couple days ago. Actually it was the reporting the news class and I needed to come up with a profile page so basically what I had to do was pitch someone that I would profile and cover for an assignment in my class that would be that is basically going to make or break my grade in this class and I have absolutely no idea who I wanted to cover because this has to be someone who is almost a complete stranger to me they can't be friends can't be family maybe coworkers cause conflict of interest and I had no idea who I was gonna pick and I was very stressed about it. I had no profile pitch or my profile cause how am I gonna profile nobody I like I couldn't think of literally anybody that I thought I could comfortably go up to and say hey would you like to be profiled you know for my assignment. I was stressed. I couldn't think of anybody I see"

OTHER FACTORS

Silas has high functioning autism and does affect with his social skills like communication, but it doesn't entirely affect his academic performance.

OVERALL SUMMARY

It was nice to interview someone from a different University and it is interesting to learn about the challenges and struggles that Journalism students face. Silas responded to all my questions with no hesitations and shared out great details. The main takeaway from this interview is that having a learning disability can affect your academic performance, but you can still overcome with your challenges with the right accommodations and courage.

INTERVIEW RESULTS - PERSON 2



NAME: Maryam Jama

COLLEGE: University of
Minnesota

GRADE: Freshman

MAJOR/MINOR: User

Experience Design

LOCATION: Online @ ZOOM

DATE: 2/23/2026

TIME: 6:55PM

ITEMS THAT THEY WISH TO HAVE FOR ACADEMIC USES

An item that Silas wishes to have is one of my silly ideas which is Robo Teach because she can have a teacher helping her when she does assignments late at night and can also help her with programming classes she'll do later down the line in her major. Another item she wishes to have is something that can remind her about assignment due dates, organize her schedule, and upload assignments.

DIFFICULT ACADEMIC TIME

"This was, this was last week actually. So my drawing class, basically the professor, he has a little bit of trouble with like canvas. So like sometimes he won't like put the assignment properly on canvas and then be like, 'oh, this is due by next class.' And so my class for that drawing class are on Monday and Wednesday. So last week he assigned us a drawing to do on Monday and he was like, OK, this is due Wednesday but at the beginning of class. So I went to go do it on Tuesday and the stuff wasn't on canvas properly. So I didn't know how to do it. And that really, really stressed me out. So I was just going off of like trying to remember what he was saying in lecture. And I think that's very stressful when things aren't uploaded how they're supposed to be and like, and like you don't know how to do the assignment. So that that really stressed me out and thankfully he realized that it wasn't up there. So he gave us an extension on it and then properly put the things on."

OTHER FACTORS

Maryam switched majors because she was more interested in technology and CDES is less difficult unlike CSE. She also believes that empathy is a big thing to have, especially if you're a professor or a TA.

OVERALL SUMMARY

Maryam is happy that I am doing research into this stress topic because this is easily relatable to students. It was nice to interview a Freshman that switched from CSE to CDES and learning that there can be stressful moments as a CDES student. I also didn't know that Maryam was a CSE student before this and it is common for CSE students to switch to a different "College of..." since CSE is a hard department. Maryam answers all my questions well with some pauses. One takeaway to learn from this interview is that as a Freshman in CSE, it can be stressful. Especially if you are taking Calc I, Physics I, and Chemistry I your very first semester in college. However, it is okay to go for a different path to you want to go for.

INTERVIEW RESULTS - PERSON 3



NAME: Dublin Flynn

COLLEGE: University of
Minnesota

GRADE: Junior

MAJOR/MINOR: Computer
Engineering

LOCATION: In-person @
Bridges Dinkytown

DATE: 2/21/2026

TIME: 9:35PM

ITEMS THAT THEY WISH TO HAVE FOR ACADEMIC USES

A website that can show past homework assignments (including the solutions) for the class so students can use them to practice more on the topic and show a step to step process on how to solve the problem. This is similar to Bison Academy (NDSU).

DIFFICULT ACADEMIC TIME

"The time that I could think about right now is actually when I took my Circuits III exam last Friday. I was expecting something on the test and I didn't see it and I felt like that I was panicking and and I wasn't able to recall the things I studied for correctly and I rushed myself and I didn't do things as best as I could even though I knew some of these things I just got in my own head when the test sort of subverted my expectations so I would say I was very stressed at the moment and even for a couple hours after the test but I eventually collected myself and on lecture today he went over it and I feel a little better about it"

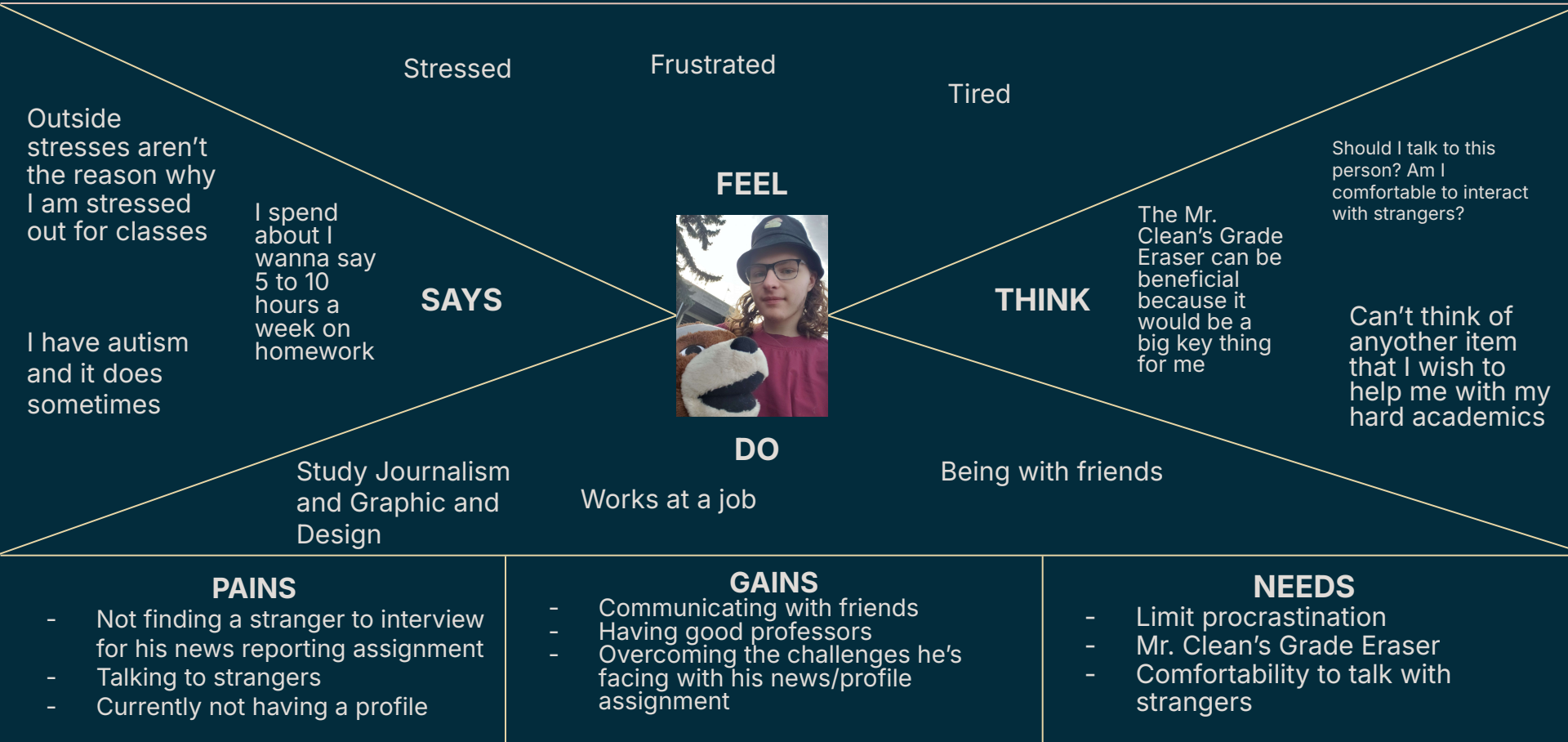
OTHER FACTORS

He has ADHD and is thinking about getting DRC accommodations so he can get extended time on exams and assignments (if possible)

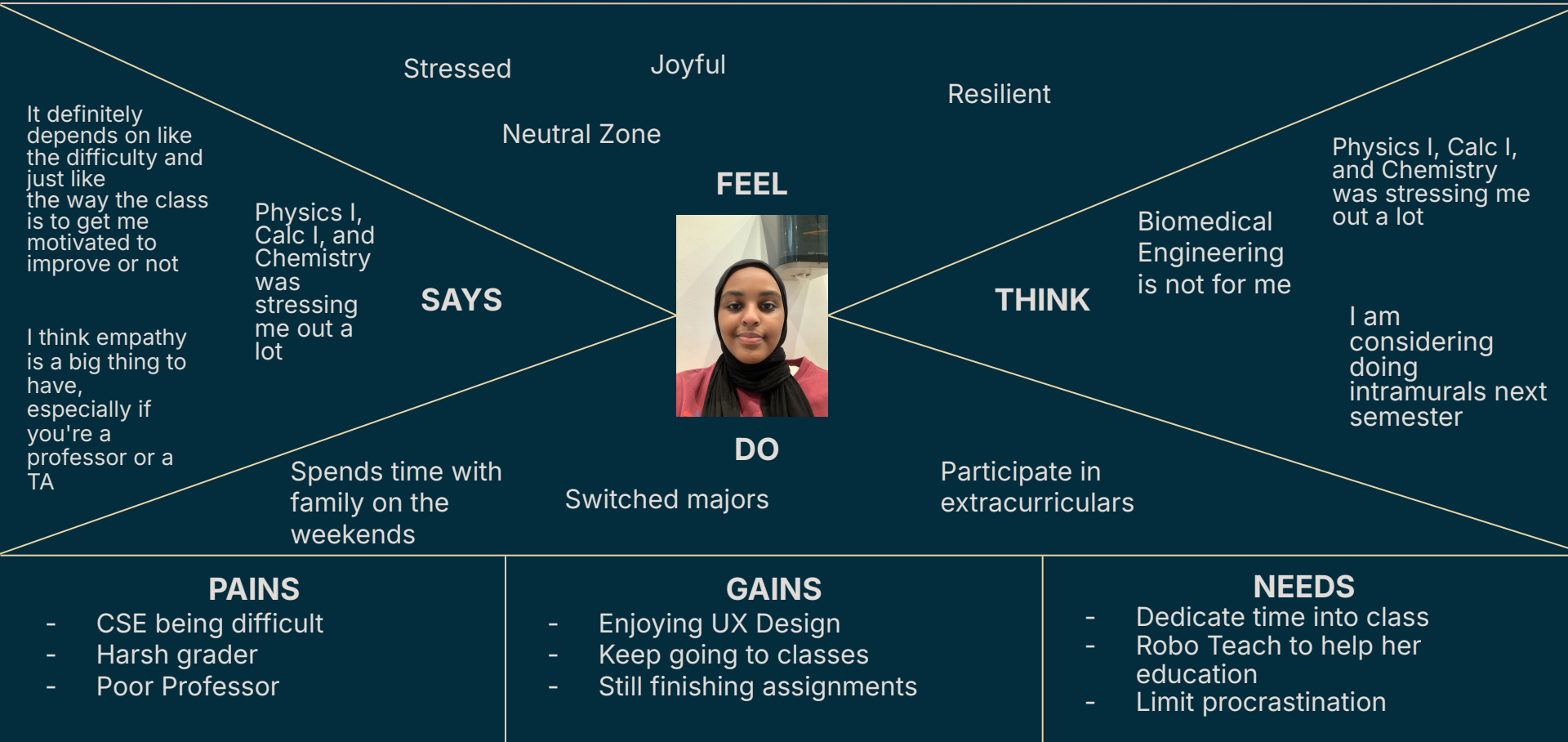
OVERALL SUMMARY

Dublin is my roommate and close friend and I would say that it was fun to interview him and to revisit some difficult events he had to face, especially during his Sophomore year. Knowing Dublin for 2.5 years, I am not surprise that he wouldn't pause or take a lot of time thinking about what to answer for the questions that I asked him. One takeaway to learn from this is that you can have mixed feeling for deciding to drop/withdraw a class. It won't be an easy decision to make, but at the same time, it's not the end of the world if you do, go with dropping a class. The silver lining is that you can still know the topics you learned and use that as an opportunity to prepare for the class the second time you take it.

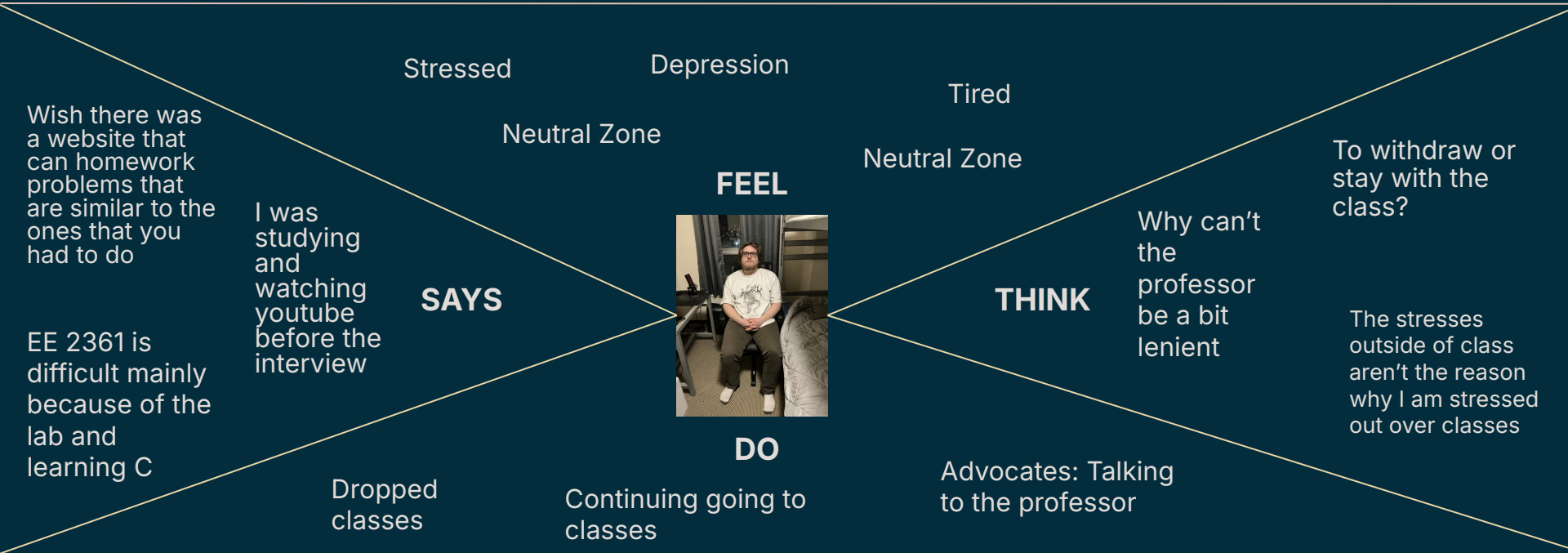
EMPATHY MAP - PERSON 1 (Silas Orta)



EMPATHY MAP - PERSON 2 (Maryam Jama)



EMPATHY MAP - PERSON 3 (Dublin Flynn)



PAINS

- Dropping/Withdrawing
- Not getting an internships
- Harsh Graders and difficult classes

GAINS

- Advocate
- Improve on the classes he dropped
- Having me who supports him

NEEDS

- Distance from distractions
- Keep on top of ADHD medication
- A UMN website that can have past HW so he can develop his knowledge on the topics
- Having DRC Accommodations



Thank you



If you have any questions, contact:
gorha079@umn.edu